THE UNIVERSITY OVERVIEW

UNIVERSITY ADMINISTRATION

Said Ladki, President

Mahmoud Halablab, Vice President for Academic Affairs

Ibrahim Akkawi, Vice President for Administration and Finance

Board of Deans

Mahmoud Halablab, Vice President for Academic Affairs

Mohammad Taha, Dean – College of Engineering

Anis El Khatib, Dean – College of Business Administration

Houssam Salami, Dean –College of Arts and Sciences

Admission

Zeina Tannir, Director

Communication and Alumni Relations

Rafal Tabbaa Khayat, Director

Finance Department

Marwa Khanji, Assistant Director of Finance

Human Resources Department

Doriah Naboulsi, Associate Director

Information Technology

Abdul Ghani Baba, Director of IT

Wassim Mallah, Director of Systems

Lina Basho, Assistant Director of IT HelpDesk

Library

Basima Katerji, Circulation Librarian

Quality Assurance and Institutional Advancement

Mirna Talhouk, Associate Director

Registrar

Nidal Khalaf, Registrar

Student Affairs

Sahar Hallak, Associate Director of Student Affairs

Campus Facilities

Ahmad Sabeh Ayoun, Director

THE UNIVERSITY

History

Establishing an educational institution that was financially and geographically accessible to all was a pressing dream for His Excellency, Prime Minister Rafik Hariri. In the early 1980s, PM Hariri chose Kfar Falous, an area between the South, the Bekaa, and the mountains, to establish a hospital and a university in collaboration with the University of Saint Joseph. However, the 1982 Israeli invasion destroyed the university and stole its equipment.

In 1984, the dream took a different turn with the establishment of the Rafik Hariri Foundation. It is a non-profit organization whose primary goal is to provide Lebanese youth with opportunities for higher education at local and international universities. Around 33,000 Lebanese students benefited from the University Loan Program of the Rafik Hariri Foundation and pursued their education in Lebanon, Europe, North Africa, and North America.

Following the end of the civil war in Lebanon, the Rafik Hariri Foundation sought to revive the dream of establishing an affordable and accessible university. Such a massive undertaking required the expertise of a country that had made significant strides in education. Although several educationally advanced countries were considered, Canada was eventually chosen for this collaboration. The programs of study at Rafik Hariri University were developed in association with several Canadian institutions, including the Canadian Bureau of International Education, the Canadian International Development Agency, Capilano University, and Memorial University.

Rafik Hariri University opened its doors for the first time on September 15, 1999, with the College of Business Administration, in accordance with the 1947 Presidential Decree. It began with an initial enrollment of 75 students. After the Colleges of Engineering and Sciences and Information Systems were established, RHU was granted university status on June 19, 2006, by Decree Number 17192.

Vision

RHU envisions becoming a beacon of knowledge, a brand for academic distinction, and a force of meaningful transformation. It strives to foster quality, institute authentic learning conditions, and support purposeful research to advance knowledge and nurture leaders capable of driving development and contributing to the enrichment of the community - immediate and beyond.

Mission

RHU shall institute quality education by committing to due process, academic excellence, and distinction. It shall create conditions conducive to farming dreams, stimulate imagination, and cultivate a passion for lifelong learning. It shall instill the

values of responsible behavior, tolerance, and freedom of self-expression and thought and align learning outcomes with emergent community needs to transcend students' potential, possibilities, and contributions beyond time and distance.

Values

When it comes to values, RHU does not merely pay lip service. It is indeed deeply committed to several core values that it upholds and fulfills:

Shared Governance. Enable all RHU constituents to participate in shaping the provision of quality higher education.

Excellence. Offer a meaningful contribution to the development of knowledge and to the promotion of teaching excellence and administrative support.

Integrity. Sustain a community of trust and operate with fairness, honesty, openness, and the highest ethical standards.

Diversity and Tolerance. Create a community that prioritizes diversity and tolerance in academic and civic life.

Community Service. Show commitment to serving our community by responding to the needs and concerns of all stakeholders.

Purposeful Learning. Engage students in a learning experience congruent with individual aspirations and community needs.

Location

RHU enjoys a superb location atop a seaside mountain overlooking the Mediterranean Sea in Mechref, Damour, a short drive from Beirut, Saida, and Mount Lebanon, in the heart of a prestigious gated community.

The RHU campus is 20 kilometers south of Beirut. It covers an area of 54,000 square meters and comprises nine buildings. Seven buildings are used for educational purposes, one for administration, and one for faculty and student residences. The campus also features basketball and volleyball courts, parking areas, a long row of Washingtonian Palm trees, vegetable gardens, a greenhouse, and beautiful open green areas.

RHU began its vegetable gardens in 2021 and selected locations behind Block A, the Dormitory Facility building, and Block G, the College of Business Administration. The landscaping team at RHU leveled the ground reasonably to prevent soil erosion and built a greenhouse for growing warm-season vegetables.

RHU's decision to grow crops is part of its sustainable campus initiative and its efforts to care for the environment. In addition to their aesthetic benefits, plants offer numerous advantages, including carbon sequestration, oxygen production, flood mitigation, and improved air quality. This also helps reduce the impact of global warming.

RHU's electricity supply comes via three routes: Mains Electrical from the EDL Grid, self-run diesel-oil generators, and the daytime-use RHU Solar-PV plant. A 100-kW-rated solar PV plant is located on the top of three of RHU's buildings, Blocks F, G, and H.

Climate

The Mechref Village in Damour is a residential project spanning elevations ranging from 30 to 560 meters above sea level. The climate is moderately cold from December to March and hot from June to September. Although the classrooms have heaters and air conditioners, students are advised to wear warm clothing during the cold season.

The lush greenery of the RHU campus creates a refreshing atmosphere and further motivates students to pursue their academic goals. The green lawns provide ample space for students to study, relax, or socialize. The mosaic of blue, green, and white—a blue sky, green lawns, and white buildings—of the RHU campus is itself magnificent.

Directions and Map

From Beirut

Take the Beirut Saida Highway south (towards Saida)
Take the Damour main exit (towards Deir Al-Qamar)
Go left at the roundabout (follow the Mechref Village road sign)
Drive for 300 meters
Take a right at the Mechref Village main gate
Follow the RHU signs leading to the Campus

From Saida

Take the Beirut Saida Highway north (towards Beirut)
Take the Damour main exit (towards Deir Al-Qamar)
Go left at the roundabout (follow the Mechref Village road sign)
Drive for 300 meters
Take a right at the Mechref Village main gate
Follow the RHU signs leading to the Campus

Map of the RHU Campus

